

Phrases and Clauses

What Is a Phrase? – Meaning and Types

A phrase is a part of a sentence which consists of a group of words that give more information about the subject, action or event in a sentence. A phrase cannot stand on its own and will not convey meaning if separated from the sentence. According to the kind of function it does, it can be classified into various types and they include the following.

- Noun Phrase
- Verb Phrase
- Adverb/Adverbial Phrase
- Prepositional Phrase
- Adjective/Adjectival Phrase

Examples of Phrases

- Rajesh and Vinod (noun phrase)
- Have been searching (verb phrase)
- Beside the trees (prepositional phrase)
- Extremely well (adverb phrase)
- The house on 6th street (noun phrase)

What Is a Clause? – Meaning and Types

A clause is also a part of a sentence that consists of a subject and a verb, unlike phrases. They can be divided into two main types depending on how they behave in a sentence. The different types of clauses are:

- Main Clause or Independent Clause
- Subordinate Clause or Dependent Clause

Examples of Clauses

- As soon as I reach the office (dependent or subordinate clause)
- I did not bring my umbrella. (independent clause)
- When the little boy saw his mom (dependent or subordinate clause)
- Collect your parcel from the courier office. (independent clause)
- Though we left home early (dependent or subordinate clause)

Difference between Phrases and Clauses

Phrases	Clauses
A phrase does not have a subject and predicate.	A clause has a subject and a predicate
A phrase is not complete, cannot make sense or convey meaning if it stands on its own.	In some cases, a clause can look complete, convey meaning and make sense when separated from the sentence.
There are five types of phrases namely noun phrase, verb phrase, adverb phrase, adjective phrase and prepositional phrase. Dr. Prashant Luthra/SSSIHL	There are two types of clauses namely independent clause and dependent clause.
Example: There is an unidentified vehicle in front of our house.	Example: I am sick, so I am going to see the doctor.

Check Your Understanding of Phrases and Clauses

- Identify the phrases and clauses in the following sentences and state which of them is a phrase and a clause.
- 1. I completed my project, but I was not satisfied with it.
- 2. Jacob knew about it; however he kept asking everyone about it.
- 3. I was waiting at the park.
Dr. Prashant Luthra/SSSIHL
- 4. They all sang extremely well.
- 5. The girls in the black dresses are the ones who won the competition last year.

Check Your Understanding of Phrases and Clauses

- Identify the phrases and clauses in the following sentences and state which of them is a phrase and a clause.
- 6. In the meantime, I will help you with your domestic chores.
- 7. Santana and Brittany are good dancers.
- 8. When we reach home, we will call you.
- 9. We were planning our summer vacation.
- 10. She finally agreed to come with us to the slumber party.

Check Your Answers

- 1. I completed my project, / but I was not satisfied with it.
- Clause / Clause
- 2. Jacob knew about it; / however he kept asking everyone about it.
- Clause / Clause
- 3. I was waiting / at the park.
- Clause / Phrase
- 4. They all sang / extremely well.
- Clause / Phrase
- 5. The girls in the black dresses are the ones / who won the competition last year.

Check Your Answers

- 6. In the meantime, / I will help you with your domestic chores.
- Phrase / Clause
- 7. Santana and Brittany are good dancers.
- Clause
- 8. When we reach home, / we will call you.
- Clause / Clause
- 9. We were planning our summer vacation.
Dr. Prashant Luthra/SSSIHL
- Clause
- 10. She finally agreed to come with us / to the slumber party.
- Clause / Clause

Exercise 1

Identify the Clause

Read the sentences and underline the subordinate clause.

1. People who pay their debts are trusted.
2. We cannot go while it is snowing.
3. Raj thinks that I have made a mistake.
4. Tina bought some chocolates which she wanted to give her brother.
5. After I reached home, it started raining.
6. Mani was asked to come to the office though he was not keeping well.
7. All that glitters is not gold.
8. Tim is the nicest person I've ever met.
9. She did not go to school as she was sick.
10. This is the boy who got suspended last week.
11. Although I was not in the mood for a movie, I watched 'Miracle in Cell No. 7' with my friend.
12. Olena likes stories that have fairies in them.
13. Riya was sure that Tia would come today.
14. Nobody knew who had come first in the race.
15. The teacher gave the students another worksheet as soon as they completed the first one.

Check Your Answers

1. People who pay their debts are trusted.
2. We cannot go while it is snowing.
3. Raj thinks that I have made a mistake.
4. Tina bought some chocolates which she wanted to give her brother.
5. After I reached home, it started raining.
6. Mani was asked to come to the office though he was not keeping well.
7. All that glitters is not gold.
8. Tim is the nicest person I've ever met.
9. She did not go to school as she was sick.
10. This is the boy who got suspended last week.
11. Although I was not in the mood for a movie, I watched 'Miracle in Cell No. 7' with my friend.
12. Olena likes stories that have fairies in them.
13. Riya was sure that Tia would come today.
14. Nobody knew who had come first in the race.
15. The teacher gave the students another worksheet as soon as they completed the first one.

Exercise 2 – Identify the type of clause

Read the sentences and identify the clause and its type.

1. You may sit wherever you like.
2. As she was not there, I spoke to her sister.
3. Will you wait till I return?
4. I fear that I shall fail.
5. I do not know what he wants.
6. I think you have made a mistake.
7. Mary had a little lamb whose fleece was white as snow.
8. Here is the copy you want.
9. She never does anything that is stupid.
10. The house that I live in belongs to my grandfather.

Check Your Answers

1. You may sit wherever you like. – Adverb Clause
2. As she was not there, I spoke to her sister. – Adverb Clause
3. Will you wait till I return? – Adverb Clause
4. I fear that I shall fail. – Noun Clause
5. I do not know what he wants. – Noun Clause
6. I think you have made a mistake. – Noun Clause
7. Mary had a little lamb whose fleece was white as snow. – Adjective Clause
8. Here is the copy you want. – Adjective Clause
9. She never does anything unless her parents allow it. – Adjective Clause
10. The house that I live in belongs to my grandfather. – Adjective Clause

SATIRAM

Dr. Prashant Luthra/SSSIHL

